in the approach. No dogma is allowed to come in the way. There is m u c h that is trivial and without any meaning or relevance for us to-day. T h e emphasis is essentially on self-realization, on knowledge of the individual self and the absolute self, both of which are said to be the same in essence. T h e objective external world is not considered unreal but real in a relative sense, an aspect of the inner reality.

There are many ambiguities in the Upanishads a n d different interpretations have been made. But that is a matter for the philosopher or scholar. T h e general tendency is towards monism and the whole approach is evidently intended to lessen the differences that must have existed then, leading to fierce debate. It is the way of synthesis. Interest in magic and such like supernatural knowledge is sternly discouraged, and ritual and cere-

monies without enlightenment are said to be in vain—'those engaged in them, considering themselves men of understanding and learned, stagger along aimlessly like blind men led by the blind, and fail to reach the goal.' Even the Vedas are treated as the lower knowledge; the higher one being that of the inner mind.